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GRACE OVER RULES
Finding Freedom in the Ancient Traditions
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Why This Book Exists

When you first start following Jesus, you hear a lot about grace. You hear that you are saved by grace. You hear that you are loved by grace. You hear that you are forgiven by grace. It sounds amazing. It sounds freeing. It sounds like good news.

Then you open the Old Testament. You read about rules. You read about laws. You read about regulations. You read about consequences for breaking the rules. You close the book. You think, "Wait. Is God a God of grace or a God of rules? Which one is it?"

I get it. I have been there. I have wondered if the God of the Old Testament is the same as the God of the New Testament. I have wondered why there are so many rules. I have wondered if I am supposed to follow them. But here is the thing. The rules were never meant to save you. They were never meant to make you righteous. They were meant to show you your need for grace. They were meant to point you to Jesus. They were meant to lead you to freedom.

This book is for you. You are new to the faith. You are trying to understand. You are trying to build a foundation. Over the next 30 days, we are going to look at 30 ancient traditions. We are going to see what they meant. We are going to see why they were given. And we are going to see how Jesus fulfilled them. And we are going to see how grace is greater than rules.

The Value You Will Get

By the end of this book, you will not be confused by the Old Testament rules. You will understand them. You will understand their purpose. You will understand their limitations. And you will understand their fulfillment. You will see that the rules were never meant to be a burden. They were meant to be a teacher. They were meant to lead you to grace. You will have a new confidence in your faith. You will have a new love for your Bible. And you will have a new appreciation for the freedom you have in Christ.

How to Use This Guide

This is a 30 day journey. Each day takes about 5 to 10 minutes. Read the old rule. Read the new grace. Read why it matters for you. Read the faith builder. Read the prayer. If you are not sure how to pray, just read the words out loud. God hears honest words. He is not looking for fancy language. He is looking for your heart.

Day 01: The Rule of the Firstborn

The Old Rule
"Consecrate to me every firstborn male. The first offspring of every womb among the Israelites belongs to me, whether human or animal." - Exodus 13:2 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

In the Old Testament, the firstborn was special. The firstborn son got a double portion of the inheritance. The firstborn got the blessing. The firstborn got the authority. But God said something else. He said the firstborn belonged to Him. It was a rule. It was a reminder of deliverance. It was a reminder of sacrifice.

The New Grace
"For those God foreknew he also predestined to be conformed to the image of his Son, that he might be the firstborn among many brothers and sisters." - Romans 8:29

Jesus is the firstborn. He is the firstborn of all creation. He is the firstborn from the dead. He is the firstborn among many brothers and sisters. He is the fulfillment of the rule. And because we are in Him, we become part of the family. We become brothers and sisters. We share in His inheritance. That is grace.

Why It Matters For You
You are new to the faith. You might feel like an outsider. You might feel like you do not belong. But the rule of the firstborn tells a different story. It tells a story of inclusion. It tells a story of family. Through Jesus, you are not an outsider. You are a son. You are a daughter. You are included. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
Do you feel like you belong? Write down one thing that makes you feel like part of God's family.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being the firstborn. Thank you for making me part of the family. Thank you for including me. Thank you for sharing your inheritance with me. Help me to live like a son. Help me to live like a daughter. Amen.

Day 02: The Rule of the Slave

The Old Rule

"If you buy a Hebrew servant, he is to serve you for six years. But in the seventh year, he shall go free, without paying anything." - Exodus 21:2 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God gave a rule about Hebrew slaves. A Hebrew slave could only serve for six years. In the seventh year, they had to go free. They did not have to pay to be free. They did not have to work for their freedom. It was a gift. It was a rule of grace.

The New Grace
"It is for freedom that Christ has set us free. Stand firm, then, and do not let yourselves be burdened again by a yoke of slavery." - Galatians 5:1

Jesus is the seventh year. He is the freedom. He is the release. He is the fulfillment of the rule. He sets us free. Not because we earned it. Not because we deserve it. Because He is grace. He is freedom.

Why It Matters For You
You might feel trapped. You might feel trapped in a bad habit. You might feel trapped in a pattern of sin. You might feel trapped in guilt. The rule of the slave tells a different story. It tells a story of freedom. It tells a story of release. Through Jesus, you are free. You do not have to pay. You do not have to work. You just have to receive. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
What are you trapped in today? Write it down. Give it to Jesus. He is the seventh year. He is your freedom.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for setting me free. Thank you for the seventh year. Thank you for the release. Thank you for the grace. Help me to walk in freedom. Help me to stop returning to slavery. Amen.

Day 03: The Rule of the Kinsman Redeemer

The Old Rule
"If one of your fellow Israelites becomes poor and sells some of their property, their nearest relative is to come and redeem what they have sold." - Leviticus 25:25 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The kinsman redeemer was a family member. If someone lost their land, a family member could buy it back. If someone sold themselves into slavery, a family member could buy them out. The redeemer had to be a relative. He had to be willing. He had to be able. It was a rule of rescue.

The New Grace
"For you know that it was not with perishable things such as silver or gold that you were redeemed from the empty way of life handed down to you from your ancestors, but with the precious blood of Christ, a lamb without blemish or defect." - 1 Peter 1:18-19

Jesus is the kinsman redeemer. He is our relative. He became human. He became one of us. He is willing. He chose to redeem us. He is able. His blood is enough. He redeemed us. He bought us back. He paid the price.

Why It Matters For You
You were in debt. You were in debt to sin. You could not pay it back. You could not buy your own freedom. But Jesus stepped in. He became your relative. He paid the price. He redeemed you. You are not your own. You are bought with a price. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
Thank Jesus for being your kinsman redeemer. Thank Him for paying the price you could not pay.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being my kinsman redeemer. Thank you for becoming human. Thank you for becoming my relative. Thank you for paying the price. Thank you for redeeming me. Help me to live as one who has been bought back. Amen.

Day 04: The Rule of the Cities of Refuge

The Old Rule
"Speak to the Israelites and say to them: 'Select some towns to be your cities of refuge, to which a person who has killed someone accidentally may flee.'" - Numbers 35:10-11 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The cities of refuge were safe places. If someone killed a person by accident, they could flee to a city of refuge. The avenger of blood could not touch them there. They were safe. They were protected. They were given a second chance. It was a rule of safety.

The New Grace
"Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus." - Romans 8:1

Jesus is the city of refuge. He is the safe place. He is the protection. He is the second chance. He is the fulfillment of the rule. When we run to Him, we are safe. We are protected. We are not condemned.

Why It Matters For You
You have made mistakes. You have done things you regret. You have felt like you were in trouble. But the cities of refuge tell a different story. They tell a story of safety. They tell a story of protection. Through Jesus, you are safe. You are protected. You are given a second chance. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
What mistake do you need to run to Jesus with? Write it down. Give it to Him. He is your safe place.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being my city of refuge. Thank you for being my safe place. Thank you for protecting me. Thank you for the second chance. Help me to run to you. Help me to stay in you. Amen.

Day 05: The Rule of the Sabbath

The Old Rule
"Remember the Sabbath day by keeping it holy. Six days you shall labor and do all your work, but the seventh day is a sabbath to the LORD your God." - Exodus 20:8-10 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The Sabbath was a day of rest. It was a day of ceasing. The people were told to stop working. They were told to stop striving. They were told to rest. They were told to trust. It was a rule of rest.

The New Grace
"Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest." - Matthew 11:28

Jesus is the Sabbath. He is the rest. He is the ceasing. He is the fulfillment of the rule. He says, "Come to me. I will give you rest." Not the rest of a day. The rest of a lifetime. Not the rest of a ceremony. The rest of a relationship.

Why It Matters For You
You are tired. You are trying to earn God's love. You are trying to be good enough. You are trying to do enough. But the Sabbath tells a different story. It tells a story of rest. Through Jesus, you can stop striving. You can stop working. You can rest. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
What are you striving for? What are you trying to earn? Write it down. Give it to Jesus. Rest in Him.

The Prayer
Jesus, I am tired. I am weary. Thank you for being my rest. Thank you for being my Sabbath. Help me to stop striving. Help me to rest in you. Amen.

Day 06: The Rule of the Unleavened Bread

The Old Rule
"Celebrate the Festival of Unleavened Bread, because it was on this very day that I brought your divisions out of Egypt." - Exodus 12:17 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

When the Israelites left Egypt, they had to leave quickly. They did not have time to let their bread rise. They baked unleavened bread. But God told them to keep celebrating this festival. For seven days every year, they were to remove all yeast from their homes. Yeast was a symbol of sin. It spreads. It puffs up. It was a rule of purity.

The New Grace
"Therefore let us keep the Festival, not with the old bread leavened with malice and wickedness, but with the bread of sincerity and truth." - 1 Corinthians 5:8

Paul applies this to Jesus. He says we are to remove the yeast of sin from our lives. We are to live with sincerity and truth. Jesus is the Bread of Life. He is the unleavened bread. He is without sin. If we want to live like Him, we must remove the yeast.

Why It Matters For You
You are new to the faith. You are learning what it means to follow Jesus. You are learning what it means to live a holy life. The rule of unleavened bread tells a story of purity. It tells a story of removing the things that separate you from God. Through Jesus, you can live a holy life. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
What is the yeast in your life? What is the thing that puffs you up? What is the thing that spreads? Write it down. Ask God to help you remove it.

The Prayer
God, help me to remove the yeast from my life. Help me to stop tolerating the things that separate me from you. Give me a heart of sincerity and truth. Help me to live a holy life. Amen.

Day 07: The Rule of the Firstfruits

The Old Rule
"Bring the best of the firstfruits of your soil to the house of the LORD your God." - Exodus 23:19 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The firstfruits was an offering. It was the first sheaf of the harvest. The Israelites were told to bring it to God. It was a sign of trust. It showed they believed God would provide the rest. But it was also a rule of faith.

The New Grace
"But Christ has indeed been raised from the dead, the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep." - 1 Corinthians 15:20

Jesus is the firstfruits. He is the first to rise from the dead. His resurrection is a promise that we too will rise. If the firstfruits is raised, the rest will be raised too. This is the hope of the Christian faith.

Why It Matters For You
You are new to the faith. You are learning about the resurrection. You are learning about eternal life. The rule of the firstfruits tells a story of hope. It tells a story of resurrection. Through Jesus, you have hope. You have eternal life. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
Do you believe in the resurrection? Do you believe that Jesus rose from the dead? Write down one thing that gives you hope.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for rising from the dead. Thank you for being the firstfruits. Thank you for the promise that we will rise too. Thank you for the hope of eternal life. Amen.

Day 08: The Rule of the Tithe

The Old Rule
"A tithe of everything from the land, whether grain from the soil or fruit from the trees, belongs to the LORD; it is holy to the LORD." - Leviticus 27:30 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The tithe was ten percent. The Israelites were told to give ten percent of their crops and their livestock to God. It was a sign of trust. It was a sign of gratitude. It was a rule of generosity.

The New Grace
"Honor the LORD with your wealth, with the firstfruits of all your crops; then your barns will be filled to overflowing, and your vats will brim over with new wine." - Proverbs 3:9-10

Jesus is the tithe. He is the ten percent. He is the firstfruits. He is the fulfillment of the rule. He gave everything. He gave one hundred percent. And because He gave everything, we can give generously. We can trust God with our money.

Why It Matters For You
You are new to the faith. You are learning about generosity. You are learning about trusting God with your resources. The rule of the tithe tells a story of trust. It tells a story of generosity. Through Jesus, you can trust God with your money. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
Do you trust God with your money? Write down one way you can be generous this week.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for giving everything for me. Thank you for being the tithe. Thank you for being the firstfruits. Help me to trust you with my money. Help me to be generous. Amen.

Day 09: The Rule of the Sabbath Year

The Old Rule
"For six years you are to sow your fields and harvest the crops, but during the seventh year let the land lie unplowed and unused." - Exodus 23:10-11 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The Sabbath Year was a year of rest for the land. It was a year of trust. The people were told not to plant. They were told not to harvest. They were told to trust God to provide. It was a year of faith. It was a rule of trust.

The New Grace
"So do not worry, saying, 'What shall we eat?' or 'What shall we drink?' or 'What shall we wear?' For the pagans run after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them." - Matthew 6:31-32

Jesus is the Sabbath Year. He is the trust. He is the rest. He is the provision. He is the fulfillment of the rule. He tells us not to worry. He tells us to trust. He tells us that the Father knows what we need.

Why It Matters For You
You are new to the faith. You are learning to trust God. You are learning to let go of worry. The Sabbath Year tells a story of provision. It tells a story of trust. Through Jesus, you can stop worrying. You can trust God. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
What are you worried about today? Write it down. Give it to God. He knows what you need.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being my Sabbath Year. Thank you for providing for me. Thank you for teaching me to trust. Help me to stop worrying. Help me to trust in you. Amen.

Day 10: The Rule of the Clean and Unclean

The Old Rule
"You must distinguish between the unclean and the clean, between living creatures that may be eaten and those that may not be eaten." - Leviticus 11:47 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The clean and unclean laws were rules about food. They were rules about touch. They were rules about disease. They were a lesson about holiness. The people were told not to eat certain animals. They were told not to touch certain things. They were told to be different from the nations around them. It was a rule of separation.

The New Grace
"The voice spoke to him a second time, 'Do not call anything impure that God has made clean.'" - Acts 10:15

Jesus is the clean and unclean. He is the transformation. He is the fulfillment of the rule. He makes the unclean clean. He makes the impure pure. He makes the unholy holy. He does

not just give a list of rules. He gives a new heart. He gives a new nature. He gives a new identity.

Why It Matters For You
You might feel unclean. You might feel impure. You might feel like you are not good enough. The clean and unclean laws tell a different story. They tell a story of transformation. Through Jesus, you are made clean. You are made pure. You are made holy. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
Do you feel unclean? Do you feel impure? Write it down. Give it to Jesus. He makes you clean.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for making me clean. Thank you for making me pure. Thank you for making me holy. Thank you for the new heart. Thank you for the new nature. Thank you for the new identity. Help me to live in that identity. Amen.

Day 11: The Rule of the Priesthood

The Old Rule
"Have Aaron your brother brought to you from among the Israelites, along with his sons Nadab and Abihu, Eleazar and Ithamar, so they may serve me as priests." - Exodus 28:1 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The priest was the mediator. He was the go-between. He represented the people before God. He offered sacrifices. He made atonement. He interceded. It was a rule of mediation.

The New Grace
"Therefore, since we have a great high priest who has ascended into heaven, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold firmly to the faith we profess." - Hebrews 4:14

Jesus is the priest. He is the mediator. He is the go-between. He is the fulfillment of the rule. He represents us before God. He intercedes for us. He understands our weaknesses. He was tempted. He did not sin. He is the perfect high priest.

Why It Matters For You
You need a mediator. You need someone to represent you. You need someone to intercede for you. The rule of the priesthood tells a story of access. It tells a story of mediation. Through Jesus, you have access to God. You have a mediator. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
Do you need a mediator today? Write down one thing you need Jesus to represent you in.

The Prayer

Jesus, thank you for being my High Priest. Thank you for representing me before God. Thank you for interceding for me. Thank you for understanding my weaknesses. Help me to come boldly to the throne of grace. Amen.

Day 12: The Rule of the Sacrifices

The Old Rule
"For the life of a creature is in the blood, and I have given it to you to make atonement for yourselves on the altar; it is the blood that makes atonement for one's life." - Leviticus 17:11 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The sacrifices were the center of the Old Testament law. They were about blood. They were about fire. They were about atonement. The people would bring an animal. They would lay their hands on it. They would confess their sin. The animal would be killed. The blood would be shed. It was a rule of atonement.

The New Grace
"In fact, the law requires that nearly everything be cleansed with blood, and without the shedding of blood there is no forgiveness." - Hebrews 9:22

Jesus is the sacrifice. He is the blood. He is the atonement. He is the fulfillment of the rule. His blood was shed. His life was given. His sacrifice was made. And because of Him, we are forgiven. We are cleansed. We are made new.

Why It Matters For You
You need forgiveness. You need atonement. You need cleansing. The rule of the sacrifices tells a story of grace. It tells a story of forgiveness. Through Jesus, you are forgiven. You are cleansed. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
What sin do you need to bring to Jesus today? Write it down. Give it to Him. He is the sacrifice.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being the sacrifice. Thank you for shedding your blood. Thank you for making atonement. Thank you for forgiving me. Help me to receive your forgiveness. Help me to live in your grace. Amen.

Day 13: The Rule of the Day of Atonement

The Old Rule
"This is to be a lasting ordinance for you: On the tenth day of the seventh month you must deny yourselves and not do any work—whether native-born or a foreigner residing among

you—because on this day atonement will be made for you, to cleanse you." - Leviticus 16:29-30 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The Day of Atonement was the holiest day of the year. It was a day of national cleansing. The high priest entered the Most Holy Place. He offered sacrifices for his own sin. He offered sacrifices for the sin of the people. The blood was sprinkled on the mercy seat. The people fasted. They waited. It was a rule of cleansing.

The New Grace
"He did not enter by means of the blood of goats and calves; but he entered the Most Holy Place once for all by his own blood, thus obtaining eternal redemption." - Hebrews 9:12

Jesus is the Day of Atonement. He is the high priest. He is the sacrifice. He entered the Most Holy Place once for all. He obtained eternal redemption. The Day of Atonement was a rehearsal. The reality is the cross.

Why It Matters For You
You need atonement. You need cleansing. You need to be made right with God. The Day of Atonement tells a story of redemption. It tells a story of cleansing. Through Jesus, you are made right. You are cleansed. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
Do you need cleansing today? Write down one area of your life that needs God's cleansing.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being my Day of Atonement. Thank you for entering the Most Holy Place. Thank you for obtaining eternal redemption. Thank you for cleansing me. Amen.

Day 14: The Rule of the Scapegoat

The Old Rule
"The goat will carry on itself all their sins to a remote place; and the man shall release it in the wilderness." - Leviticus 16:22 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The scapegoat was not sacrificed. It was sent away. The high priest would lay his hands on the head of the goat. He would confess the sins of the people. He would transfer the guilt onto the goat. Then the goat would be led into the wilderness. It would carry the sins away. It was a rule of removal.

The New Grace
"We all, like sheep, have gone astray, each of us has turned to our own way; and the LORD has laid on him the iniquity of us all." - Isaiah 53:6

Jesus is the scapegoat. The sins of the world were laid on Him. He carried them away. He took them to the wilderness of the cross. He took them to the grave. He removed them from us. This is the fulfillment of the rule.

Why It Matters For You
You need your sins removed. You need them carried away. You need them gone. The rule of the scapegoat tells a story of removal. It tells a story of grace. Through Jesus, your sins are removed. They are carried away. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
What sin do you need to let go of today? Write it down. Give it to Jesus. He carried it away.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being my scapegoat. Thank you for carrying my sins away. Thank you for taking them to the grave. Thank you for removing them as far as the East is from the West. Help me to stop picking them back up. Amen.

Day 15: The Rule of the Red Heifer

The Old Rule
"Tell the Israelites to bring you a red heifer without defect or blemish and that has never been under a yoke." - Numbers 19:2 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The red heifer was a sacrifice for cleansing. The red heifer was taken outside the camp. It was killed. It was burned. Its ashes were collected. They were mixed with water. They were sprinkled on the people. They were cleansed. It was a rule of purification.

The New Grace
"The high priest carries the blood of animals into the Most Holy Place as a sin offering, but the bodies are burned outside the camp. And so Jesus also suffered outside the city gate to make the people holy through his own blood." - Hebrews 13:11-12

Jesus is the red heifer. He suffered outside the city gate. He was burned. He was the ultimate cleansing. His blood cleanses us. His blood purifies us. He is the fulfillment of the rule.

Why It Matters For You
You need cleansing. You need purification. You need to be made holy. The red heifer tells a story of cleansing. It tells a story of grace. Through Jesus, you are cleansed. You are purified. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
What area of your life needs purification today? Write it down. Give it to Jesus.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being the red heifer. Thank you for suffering outside the gate. Thank you for cleansing me. Cleanse my heart today. Amen.

Day 16: The Rule of the Bronze Serpent

The Old Rule
"So Moses made a bronze snake and put it up on a pole. Then when anyone was bitten by a snake and looked at the bronze snake, they lived." - Numbers 21:9 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The people of Israel were in the wilderness. They were complaining. They were sinning. God sent fiery serpents to bite them. Many died. The people cried out for mercy. God told Moses to make a bronze serpent. He told him to put it on a pole. Whoever looked at it would live. It was a rule of faith.

The New Grace
"Just as Moses lifted up the snake in the wilderness, so the Son of Man must be lifted up, that everyone who believes may have eternal life in him." - John 3:14-15

Jesus is the bronze serpent. He was lifted up on a cross. He was raised up on a pole. Whoever looks at Him will live. Whoever believes in Him will have eternal life. It is not about your effort. It is about looking. It is about trusting. It is about believing.

Why It Matters For You
You need to look. You need to trust. You need to believe. The bronze serpent tells a story of faith. It tells a story of life. Through Jesus, you can look and live. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
Are you looking at Jesus today? Write down one thing you are trusting Him for.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being lifted up for me. Thank you for being raised on a cross. Thank you for the promise that whoever looks at you will live. I am looking at you. I am trusting in you. I am believing in you. Amen.

Day 17: The Rule of the Cities of Refuge

The Old Rule
"Speak to the Israelites and say to them: 'Select some towns to be your cities of refuge, to which a person who has killed someone accidentally may flee.'" - Numbers 35:10-11 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The cities of refuge were safe places. They were places of protection. If someone killed a person by accident, they could flee to a city of refuge. The avenger of blood could not touch them there. They were safe. They were protected. They were given a second chance. It was a rule of safety.

The New Grace

"Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus." - Romans 8:1

Jesus is the city of refuge. He is the safe place. He is the protection. He is the second chance. He is the fulfillment of the rule. When we run to Him, we are safe. We are protected. We are not condemned.

Why It Matters For You
You need a safe place. You need protection. You need a second chance. The cities of refuge tell a story of safety. It tells a story of grace. Through Jesus, you are safe. You are protected. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
Do you need a safe place today? Write down one thing you need protection from.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being my city of refuge. Thank you for being my safe place. Thank you for protecting me. Thank you for the second chance. Help me to run to you. Help me to stay in you. Amen.

Day 18: The Rule of the Sabbath Year

The Old Rule
"For six years you are to sow your fields and harvest the crops, but during the seventh year let the land lie unplowed and unused." - Exodus 23:10-11 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The Sabbath Year was a year of rest for the land. It was a year of trust. The people were told not to plant. They were told not to harvest. They were told to trust God to provide. It was a year of faith. It was a rule of trust.

The New Grace
"So do not worry, saying, 'What shall we eat?' or 'What shall we drink?' or 'What shall we wear?' For the pagans run after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them." - Matthew 6:31-32

Jesus is the Sabbath Year. He is the trust. He is the rest. He is the provision. He is the fulfillment of the rule. He tells us not to worry. He tells us to trust. He tells us that the Father knows what we need.

Why It Matters For You
You need to trust. You need to rest. You need to stop worrying. The Sabbath Year tells a story of provision. It tells a story of trust. Through Jesus, you can stop worrying. You can trust God. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
What are you worried about today? Write it down. Give it to God. He knows what you need.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being my Sabbath Year. Thank you for providing for me. Thank you for teaching me to trust. Help me to stop worrying. Help me to trust in you. Amen.

Day 19: The Rule of the Jubilee

The Old Rule
"Consecrate the fiftieth year and proclaim liberty throughout the land to all its inhabitants. It shall be a jubilee for you; each of you is to return to your family property and to your own clan." - Leviticus 25:10 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The Year of Jubilee was a year of freedom. It was a year of release. It was a year of restoration. Every fifty years, the Israelites were to proclaim liberty. Slaves were set free. Debts were cancelled. Land was returned. It was a reset. It was a fresh start. It was a rule of freedom.

The New Grace
"The Spirit of the Lord is on me, because he has anointed me to proclaim good news to the poor. He has sent me to proclaim freedom for the prisoners and recovery of sight for the blind, to set the oppressed free, to proclaim the year of the Lord's favor." - Luke 4:18-19

Jesus is the Jubilee. He is the freedom. He is the release. He is the restoration. He is the fulfillment of the rule. He proclaims good news to the poor. He proclaims freedom to the prisoners. He sets the oppressed free.

Why It Matters For You
You need freedom. You need release. You need restoration. The Jubilee tells a story of freedom. It tells a story of grace. Through Jesus, you are free. You are restored. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
What do you need freedom from today? Write it down. Give it to Jesus. He is your Jubilee.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being my Jubilee. Thank you for proclaiming freedom to me. Thank you for releasing me from bondage. Thank you for restoring me. Help me to walk in your freedom. Amen.

Day 20: The Rule of the Firstborn

The Old Rule
"Consecrate to me every firstborn male. The first offspring of every womb among the Israelites belongs to me, whether human or animal." - Exodus 13:2 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The firstborn was special. The firstborn got the blessing. The firstborn got the inheritance. But God had a rule about the firstborn. The firstborn belonged to God. It was a reminder of deliverance. It was a rule of dedication.

The New Grace
"For those God foreknew he also predestined to be conformed to the image of his Son, that he might be the firstborn among many brothers and sisters." - Romans 8:29

Jesus is the firstborn. He is the firstborn of all creation. He is the firstborn from the dead. He is the firstborn among many brothers and sisters. He is the fulfillment of the rule. And because we are in Him, we become part of the family.

Why It Matters For You
You are part of the family. You are included. You are not an outsider. The rule of the firstborn tells a story of inclusion. It tells a story of family. Through Jesus, you are a son. You are a daughter. You are included. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
Do you feel like you belong? Write down one thing that makes you feel like part of God's family.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being the firstborn. Thank you for making me part of the family. Thank you for including me. Amen.

Day 21: The Rule of the Slave

The Old Rule
"If you buy a Hebrew servant, he is to serve you for six years. But in the seventh year, he shall go free, without paying anything." - Exodus 21:2 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God gave a rule about Hebrew slaves. A Hebrew slave could only serve for six years. In the seventh year, they had to go free. They did not have to pay to be free. It was a gift. It was a rule of grace.

The New Grace
"It is for freedom that Christ has set us free. Stand firm, then, and do not let yourselves be burdened again by a yoke of slavery." - Galatians 5:1

Jesus is the seventh year. He is the freedom. He is the release. He is the fulfillment of the rule. He sets us free. Not because we earned it. Not because we deserve it. Because He is grace. He is freedom.

Why It Matters For You

You are free. You are released. You are no longer a slave. The rule of the slave tells a story of freedom. It tells a story of grace. Through Jesus, you are free. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
What are you still in bondage to? Write it down. Give it to Jesus. He is your freedom.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for setting me free. Thank you for the seventh year. Thank you for the release. Help me to walk in freedom. Amen.

Day 22: The Rule of the Kinsman Redeemer

The Old Rule
"If one of your fellow Israelites becomes poor and sells some of their property, their nearest relative is to come and redeem what they have sold." - Leviticus 25:25 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The kinsman redeemer was a family member. He was a rescuer. He was a redeemer. He bought back what was lost. He bought back what was sold. He was a rule of redemption.

The New Grace
"For you know that it was not with perishable things such as silver or gold that you were redeemed from the empty way of life handed down to you from your ancestors, but with the precious blood of Christ, a lamb without blemish or defect." - 1 Peter 1:18-19

Jesus is the kinsman redeemer. He is our relative. He became human. He is willing. He chose to redeem us. He is able. His blood is enough. He redeemed us.

Why It Matters For You
You have been redeemed. You have been bought back. You have been rescued. The rule of the kinsman redeemer tells a story of redemption. It tells a story of grace. Through Jesus, you are redeemed. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
Thank Jesus for being your kinsman redeemer. Thank Him for paying the price you could not pay.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being my kinsman redeemer. Thank you for becoming my relative. Thank you for paying the price. Thank you for redeeming me. Amen.

Day 23: The Rule of the Sabbath

The Old Rule

"Remember the Sabbath day by keeping it holy. Six days you shall labor and do all your work, but the seventh day is a sabbath to the LORD your God." - Exodus 20:8-10 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The Sabbath was a day of rest. It was a day of ceasing. The people were told to stop working. They were told to rest. They were told to trust. It was a rule of rest.

The New Grace
"Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest." - Matthew 11:28

Jesus is the Sabbath. He is the rest. He is the ceasing. He is the fulfillment of the rule. He says, "Come to me. I will give you rest."

Why It Matters For You
You need rest. You need peace. You need to stop striving. The Sabbath tells a story of rest. It tells a story of grace. Through Jesus, you can rest. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
What are you striving for? Write it down. Give it to Jesus. Rest in Him.

The Prayer
Jesus, I am tired. I am weary. Thank you for being my rest. Help me to stop striving. Help me to rest in you. Amen.

Day 24: The Rule of the Unleavened Bread

The Old Rule
"Celebrate the Festival of Unleavened Bread, because it was on this very day that I brought your divisions out of Egypt." - Exodus 12:17 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

When the Israelites left Egypt, they had to leave quickly. They baked unleavened bread. God told them to keep celebrating this festival. For seven days every year, they were to remove all yeast from their homes. Yeast was a symbol of sin. It was a rule of purity.

The New Grace
"Therefore let us keep the Festival, not with the old bread leavened with malice and wickedness, but with the bread of sincerity and truth." - 1 Corinthians 5:8

Paul applies this to Jesus. He says we are to remove the yeast of sin from our lives. We are to live with sincerity and truth. Jesus is the Bread of Life. He is the unleavened bread.

Why It Matters For You
You are learning to live a holy life. You are learning to remove the things that separate you from God. The rule of unleavened bread tells a story of purity. It tells a story of grace. Through Jesus, you can live a holy life. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
What is the yeast in your life? Write it down. Ask God to help you remove it.

The Prayer
God, help me to remove the yeast from my life. Give me a heart of sincerity and truth. Help me to live a holy life. Amen.

Day 25: The Rule of the Firstfruits

The Old Rule
"Bring the best of the firstfruits of your soil to the house of the LORD your God." - Exodus 23:19 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The firstfruits was an offering. It was the first sheaf of the harvest. The Israelites were told to bring it to God. It was a sign of trust. It was a sign of gratitude. It was a rule of faith.

The New Grace
"But Christ has indeed been raised from the dead, the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep." - 1 Corinthians 15:20

Jesus is the firstfruits. He is the first to rise from the dead. His resurrection is a promise that we too will rise.

Why It Matters For You
You have hope. You have eternal life. The rule of the firstfruits tells a story of hope. It tells a story of resurrection. Through Jesus, you have hope. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
Do you believe in the resurrection? Write down one thing that gives you hope.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for rising from the dead. Thank you for being the firstfruits. Thank you for the promise that we will rise too. Amen.

Day 26: The Rule of the Tithe

The Old Rule
"A tithe of everything from the land, whether grain from the soil or fruit from the trees, belongs to the LORD; it is holy to the LORD." - Leviticus 27:30 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The tithe was ten percent. The Israelites were told to give ten percent of their crops and their livestock to God. It was a sign of trust. It was a sign of gratitude. It was a rule of generosity.

The New Grace

"Honor the LORD with your wealth, with the firstfruits of all your crops; then your barns will be filled to overflowing, and your vats will brim over with new wine." - Proverbs 3:9-10

Jesus is the tithe. He gave everything. He gave one hundred percent. And because He gave everything, we can give generously. We can trust God with our money.

Why It Matters For You
You are learning about generosity. You are learning about trusting God with your resources. The rule of the tithe tells a story of trust. It tells a story of grace. Through Jesus, you can trust God with your money. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
Do you trust God with your money? Write down one way you can be generous this week.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for giving everything for me. Help me to trust you with my money. Help me to be generous. Amen.

Day 27: The Rule of the Clean and Unclean

The Old Rule
"You must distinguish between the unclean and the clean, between living creatures that may be eaten and those that may not be eaten." - Leviticus 11:47 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The clean and unclean laws were rules about food and touch and disease. They were a lesson about holiness. The people were told not to eat certain animals. They were told not to touch certain things. They were told to be different from the nations around them. It was a rule of separation.

The New Grace
"The voice spoke to him a second time, 'Do not call anything impure that God has made clean.'" - Acts 10:15

Jesus is the clean and unclean. He is the transformation. He makes the unclean clean. He makes the impure pure. He makes the unholy holy.

Why It Matters For You
You might feel unclean. You might feel impure. You might feel like you are not good enough. The clean and unclean laws tell a different story. They tell a story of transformation. Through Jesus, you are made clean. You are made pure. You are made holy. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
Do you feel unclean? Write it down. Give it to Jesus. He makes you clean.

The Prayer

Jesus, thank you for making me clean. Thank you for making me pure. Thank you for making me holy. Amen.

Day 28: The Rule of the Priesthood

The Old Rule
"Have Aaron your brother brought to you from among the Israelites, along with his sons Nadab and Abihu, Eleazar and Ithamar, so they may serve me as priests." - Exodus 28:1 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The priest was the mediator. He was the go-between. He represented the people before God. He offered sacrifices. He made atonement. He interceded. It was a rule of mediation.

The New Grace
"Therefore, since we have a great high priest who has ascended into heaven, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold firmly to the faith we profess." - Hebrews 4:14

Jesus is the priest. He is the mediator. He is the go-between. He represents us before God. He intercedes for us. He understands our weaknesses.

Why It Matters For You
You need a mediator. You need someone to represent you. You need someone to intercede for you. The rule of the priesthood tells a story of access. It tells a story of grace. Through Jesus, you have access to God. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
Do you need a mediator today? Write down one thing you need Jesus to represent you in.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being my High Priest. Thank you for representing me before God. Thank you for interceding for me. Amen.

Day 29: The Rule of the Sacrifices

The Old Rule
"For the life of a creature is in the blood, and I have given it to you to make atonement for yourselves on the altar; it is the blood that makes atonement for one's life." - Leviticus 17:11 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The sacrifices were the center of the Old Testament law. They were about blood. They were about fire. They were about atonement. The people would bring an animal. They would lay their hands on it. They would confess their sin. The animal would be killed. The blood would be shed. It was a rule of atonement.

The New Grace
"In fact, the law requires that nearly everything be cleansed with blood, and without the shedding of blood there is no forgiveness." - Hebrews 9:22

Jesus is the sacrifice. He is the blood. He is the atonement. His blood was shed. His life was given. His sacrifice was made. And because of Him, we are forgiven.

Why It Matters For You
You need forgiveness. You need atonement. You need cleansing. The rule of the sacrifices tells a story of grace. It tells a story of forgiveness. Through Jesus, you are forgiven. That is grace over rules.

Faith Builder
What sin do you need to bring to Jesus today? Write it down. Give it to Him.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being the sacrifice. Thank you for shedding your blood. Thank you for making atonement. Thank you for forgiving me. Amen.

Day 30: Grace Over Rules

The Old Rule
"The law is only a shadow of the good things that are coming—not the realities themselves." - Hebrews 10:1 (Written around 60 A.D.)

The law was a shadow. It was a shadow of the good things that are coming. It was a shadow of the realities themselves. It was a shadow of Jesus. The law could not make perfect. The sacrifices could not make perfect. They were shadows. They were pointing to something greater.

The New Grace
"These are a shadow of the things that were to come; the reality, however, is found in Christ." - Colossians 2:17

Jesus is the reality. He is the substance. He is the fulfillment of the shadow. He is the good thing that is coming. He is the perfect one. He is the one who makes perfect. He is grace.

Why It Matters For You
You have grace. You have Jesus. You do not need to keep looking at rules. You can live in the reality. You can live in the substance. You can live in Christ. You have freedom. You have grace over rules.

Faith Builder
What is one thing you have learned about grace over the last 30 days? Write it down.

The Prayer

Jesus, thank you for being the reality. Thank you for being the substance. Thank you for being grace. Help me to stop living under rules. Help me to live in grace. Help me to live in you. Amen.

END MATTER

The 30-Day Grace Challenge
You have journeyed through 30 ancient rules. Now what? I challenge you to read the book of Galatians. It is 6 chapters. It is the perfect follow-up to this book. It will show you how the law was a guardian, a tutor, a shadow. And it will show you how Jesus is the substance. As you read, look for the rules. Look for the grace. Look for Jesus.

A Note on Faith
The rules are evidence. They are evidence of a divine plan. But evidence does not save you. The rules point to a person. The rules point to Jesus. You can understand the rules and still miss the grace. The invitation is for your heart. Jesus said, "Here I am! I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, I will come in." The rules are on the table. The door is open. It is your choice.

About the Author
[Author Name] writes for the spiritually curious. He is passionate about showing people the hidden wisdom of the Bible. He lives with his family and enjoys good coffee and long conversations with skeptics. He believes that honest questions deserve honest answers.

Coming Next: The Real Meaning of the Passover
If you enjoyed this journey, the next book in the series goes deeper. The Real Meaning of the Passover takes a 30 day look at how the Old Testament ceremonies point to Jesus. It is for the new believer who wants to go further.

Final Call to Action
Scan the QR code below to get the next book in the series. Visit our website to download a free reading plan. Join our community of seekers. The investigation is not over. The adventure is just beginning.